‘faster, more inclusive and sustainable growth’ process. It is the first time that a five year plan has sustainability as a prominent focus. The Twelfth Plan outlined lower carbon growth strategies adding momentum to the ongoing policies and programmes of the government on environment and climate change. To add to this, State Action Plans on Climate Change (SAPCC), a recent initiative, will tune national initiatives on the National Action Plan on Climate Change (NAPCC) to regional, socio- economic and ecological conditions. The SAPCC is expected to take off as part of the plan scheme for states. With these developments, it is clear that sustainable development and climate change issues are being addressed on a priority basis.

The world population crossed the 7 billion mark but with continued decline in population growth rates. Urbanisation continues to grow with more demand for resources. A United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) study, ***‘Keeping Track of Our Changing Environment: From Rio to Rio + 20 (1992- 2012)’***, tells the story of where the world collectively stands today on the sustainability and environment front. According to this study, both global gross domestic product (GDP) and the human development index (HDI increased by 2.5 per cent per year) continue to increase but variation and inequalities between regions still exist. The study also points to the growing pressure on agriculture, water, fisheries, and land resources. Pressure on natural resources reflected in per capita global use of natural resource materials has increased around 27 per cent between 1992 and 2005 though there has been a decline in emissions and energy and material use per unit of output, indicating improvement in efficiency levels. At the same time, global greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions have continuously been rising. GHG emissions measured in **$MtCO_2$ e** (million metric tons of CO_2 equivalent) from 1990 to 2005 register an increase of 25.9 per cent *(World Resources Institute).*

Positive and rising trends in global efforts are competing against mixed trends.In 2011, global investment in the renewable energy sector, went up 17 per cent to $257 billion hitting another record. In terms of new capacity added in 2011, renewable power (excluding large hydro Electrical project) accounted for 44 per cent of the total new generation capacity added worldwide; up from 34 per cent in 2010 (Frankfurt School of Finance and